

The perception of French prosody by Turkish learners:

A case of positive transfer?

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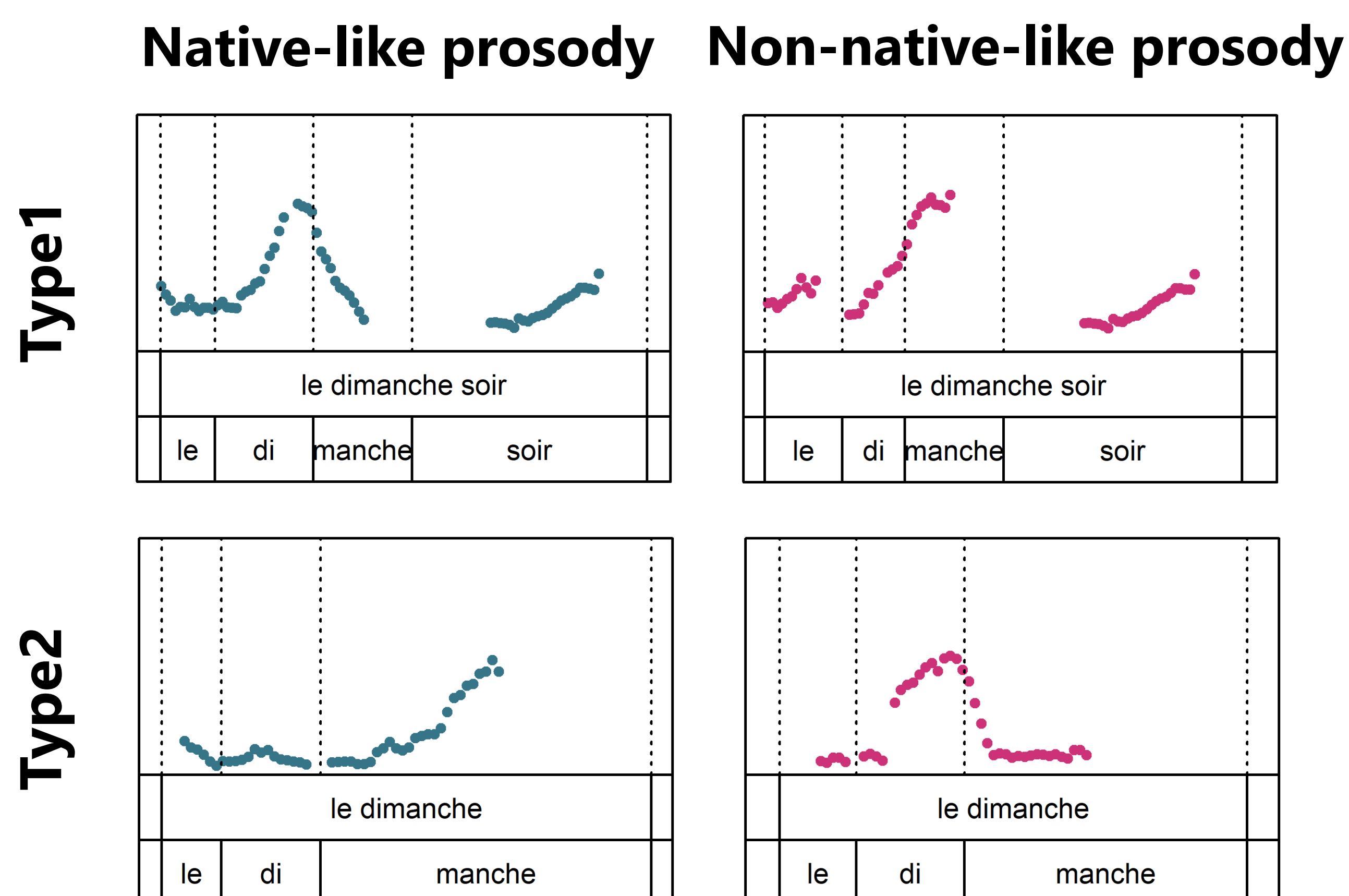
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Background

- **Turkish** listeners have shown **reduced sensitivity** to **prosodic prominence** in metalinguistic judgement tasks in their **native language** [1] and **L2 English** [2].
- **Turkish** and **French** prosodic systems share **similarities**, in that prominence is generally assigned **post-lexically** to the **final syllable** of a prosodic unit (Turkish: Prosodic Word [3], French: Accentual Phrase [4]).

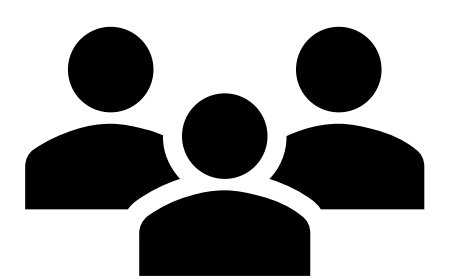
Can Turkish learners of French benefit from these similarities in their perception of French native-like and non-native-like prominence patterns?

Methods



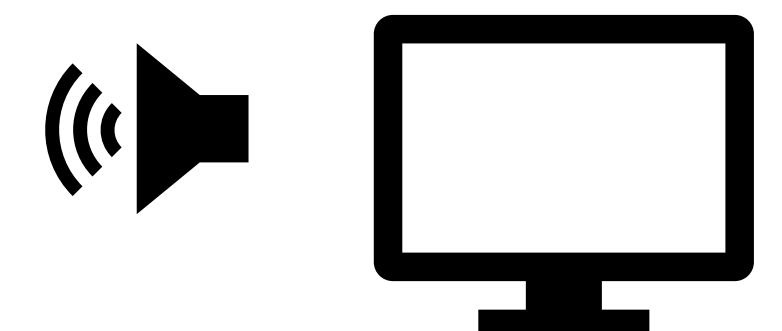
Participants:

- 23 Turkish learners of French
- 19-32 years old, university students of French
- Age of Onset: mean = 18 years, sd = 1.95

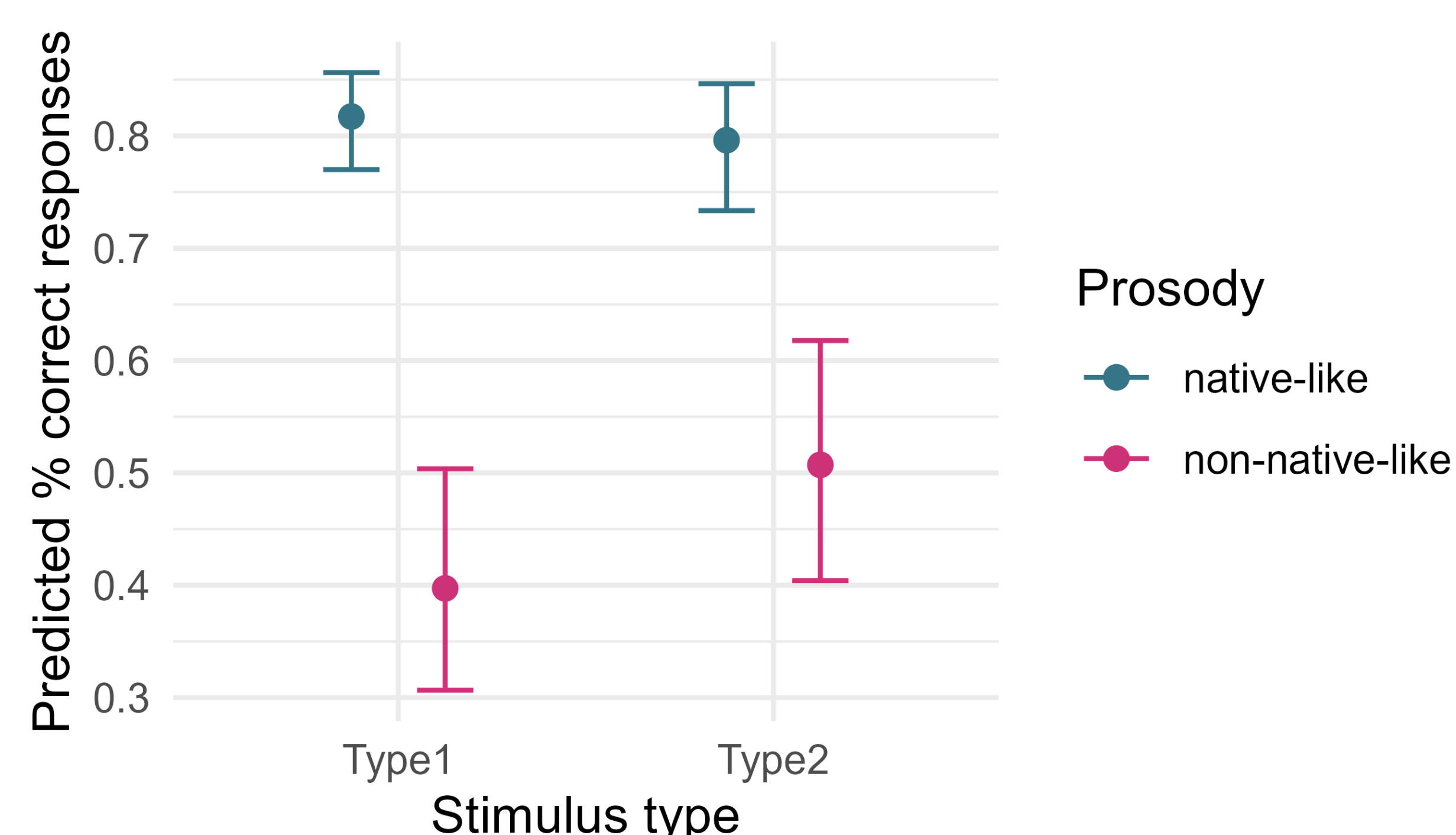


Procedure:

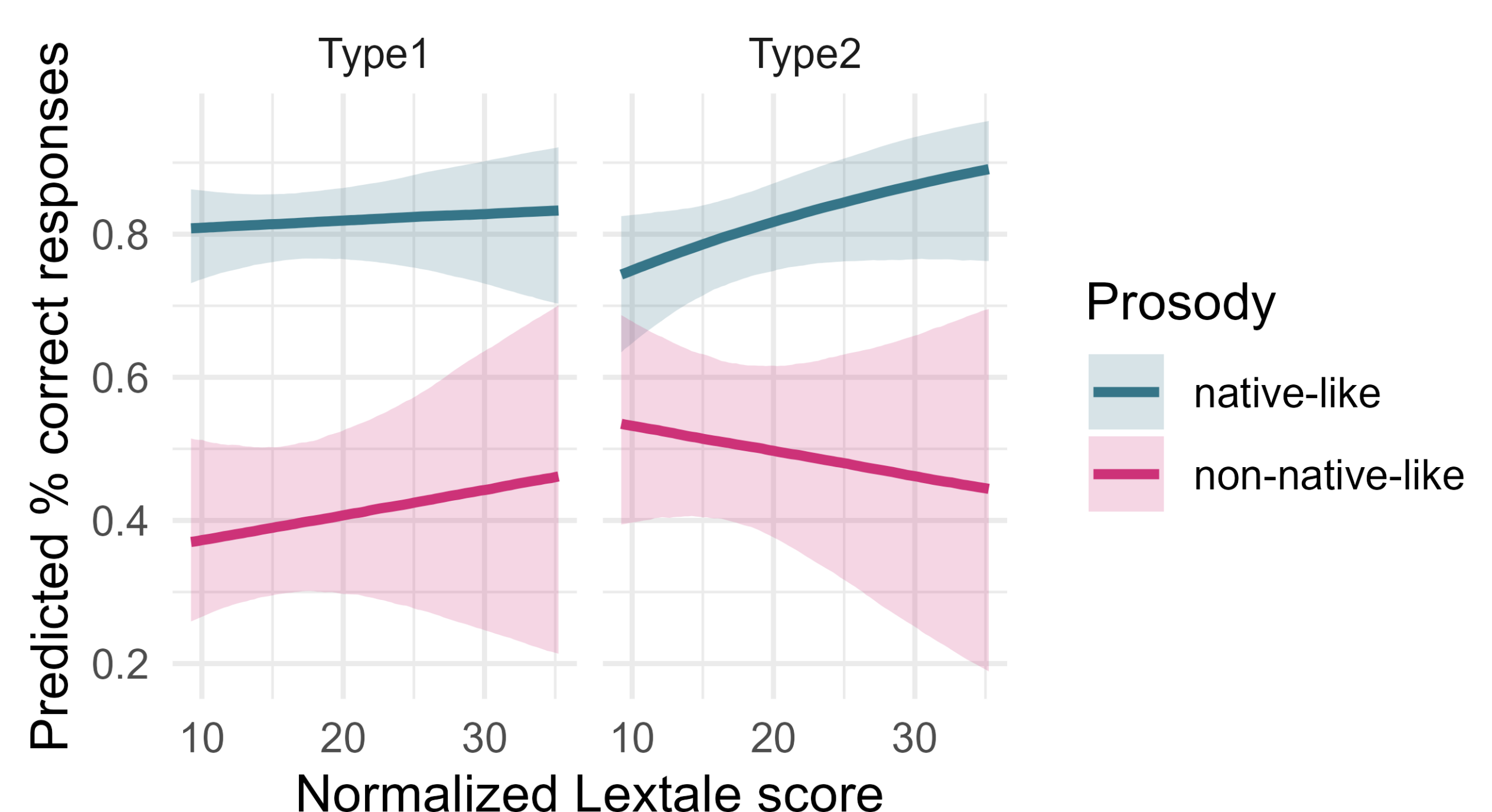
- Auditory rating task:
Est-ce que l'intonation du mot « XX » a été correcte ou non ?
- 200 trials (50 items * 2 types * 2 prosodic conditions)
- Proficiency was assessed via Lextale_FR [5].



Main results



Results by proficiency



Conclusions

- **Turkish learners** of **French** accurately identify **native-like prosodic prominence** patterns, but struggle to reject **non-native-like** patterns, especially those entailing **word-final prominence** (Type1).
- This could reflect a **negative transfer** (Turkish assigns prominence at the level of the Prosodic Word) or an **incorrect generalization** that French exhibits final prominence at the word level.

References: [1] Domahs, U., S. Genc, J. Knaus, R. Wiese & B. Kabak. 2013. Processing (un-)predictable word stress: ERP evidence from Turkish. *Language and Cognitive Processes*, 28(3):335–354. [2] Altmann, H.. 2006. *The perception and production of second language stress: A cross-linguistic experimental study*. PhD thesis, University of Delaware. [3] Özçelik, Ö. 2023. Prosody in Turkish. In K. Bogomolets & H. van der Hulst (eds.), *Word prominence in languages with complex morphologies*, 493–591. Oxford University Press. [4] Jun, S.-A. & C. Fougeron. 2000. A phonological model of French intonation. In A. Botinis (ed.), *Intonation: Analysis, modelling and technology*, 209–242. Springer. [5] Brysbaert, M. 2013. Lextale_FR A fast, free, and efficient test to measure language proficiency in French. *Psychologica Belgica*, 53(1), 23–37.

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